Pick a niche and an offer that sells itself

A 10-minute worksheet for anyone selling to local businesses: websites, SEO, Google profiles, reviews, social, ads or automations. Do this before you look for a single lead: it decides who you call, what you say and what you charge.

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1. Score 3 to 5 trades in your town

Open Google Maps, search `[trade] in [your town]` for each trade you're considering, and score it 1 to 5 on each line.

	What it means	1	5
Job value	What one customer is worth to them (one job × how often they come back)	under $150	$1,000+
Gaps	How many listings show the problem YOU fix (see "What a gap looks like" below)	almost none	1 in 5 or more
Busy	How many have 20+ reviews at 4.5★ or better (busy, trusted, missing the obvious)	a few	most of them
Reachable	Phone listed, a storefront you can walk into, owner-run	call centres, chains	owner answers
Your edge	You know the trade, know someone in it, or actually like it	none	strong

Trade	Job value	Gaps	Busy	Reachable	Your edge	Total /25
example: pressure washing, Tulsa	4	3	4	5	2	18

What a gap looks like, for what you sell

You sell	Count the listings that…
Websites	have no Website button, or a site that's broken, "Not secure" or clearly old (© 2021 or earlier)
Local SEO	have good reviews but don't show in the top 3 map results for "[trade] in [town]", or one page for every service

Google profile + reviews	have fewer than 20 reviews, no review in the last 3 months, few photos, or reviews with no owner reply
Social media	have no Facebook/Instagram linked, or the last post is 3+ months old
Ads	sit under competitors' Sponsored results or Local Services Ads for their own trade and town, with none of their own
Automations (booking, missed-call text-back, chat)	say "call for a quote" with no online booking, or have reviews about "no answer" or "never called back"

18 or more: start there. Pick ONE trade and ONE area for your first 30 days. "The website person for pressure washers in Tulsa" is easier to say, easier to trust and easier to price than "I do websites". Same for "the reviews person for dentists in Mesa" vs "I do marketing".

For scale, a real search (Google Maps, Oct 2026): "pressure washing in Tulsa OK" had 72 listings, 10 without a Website button. Busy trades in the suburbs and smaller towns next to a city usually have more gaps than downtown.

Good trades to score first: pressure washing, landscaping and lawn care, tree service, junk removal, painting, fencing, decks, handyman, cleaning, mobile detailing, pool service, pest control. Higher-ticket (bigger fees, harder sell): roofing, HVAC, remodeling, clinics, dental, law.

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2. Sell the outcome, not the website

Owners don't want "a website", "SEO" or "content". They want the phone to ring. Fill in your one-line offer:

> I help **[trade]** in **[area]** get more **[calls / booked jobs]** from Google, with a site that shows every service and every town they cover, **[plus the monthly thing you do]**.

Examples:

- Websites: *"I help pressure washers around Tulsa get more booked jobs from Google, with a site that shows every service and every town they cover, plus a page a month and a review system that keeps them on top."*
- Reviews: *"I help dentists in Mesa get a steady stream of fresh Google reviews, so new patients pick them over the practice down the street."*
- Automations: *"I make sure every missed call at your shop gets a text back in a minute, so the job doesn't go to the next company on the list."*

Websites open the door. A free preview of their own site is the easiest "yes" to get, whatever you sell after it: SEO, reviews and the monthly plan are what they stay for.

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3. Three packages (you set the prices)

Most owners pick the middle option, so make the middle one the one you want to sell.

	Starter	Get Calls (recommended)	Grow
What they get	Site live: home, services, contact, call button	Starter + a page for every service and town + Google Business Profile set up properly	Get Calls + monthly SEO pages, a review-request system, a one-page monthly report
Price shape	one-time	one-time + small monthly (hosting)	monthly

Selling something else? Keep the same shape: a one-time setup, a recommended monthly plan, a bigger monthly plan. For reviews, that's the review-request setup / monthly requests + replies to every review / that plus profile posts and photos. For automations: one missed-call text-back / text-back + online booking / that plus follow-ups and reminders.

What the market charges, for reference (full table in the free "2026 price guide"): freelancers' most common website bands are $1,000–$2,500 and $2,500–$5,000; the most common local SEO retainer is $501–$1,000 a month (local SEO averages $1,557, Ahrefs); Google profile management runs about $125–$600 per location a month; managed reviews $500–$1,000 a month for a small business. You don't have to start there: lower prices while you build proof are fine, as long as you raise them once you have results.

Payment terms that protect you: 50% up front, 50% at launch; monthly billed in advance; 30 days' notice to cancel.

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4. The founding-client deal (your first 2 or 3)

No portfolio yet? Offer your first 2 or 3 clients a lower price in exchange for three things, in writing:

1. A testimonial you can quote (in their words, approved by them)
2. Permission to show their before and after as a case study
3. One introduction to another business owner they know

Ask for an honest Google review the same way you'd ask any client, but never as part of the deal: Google doesn't allow reviews in exchange for discounts or anything else.

Make it honest and time-limited: *"I'm taking 3 founding clients in [area] this month at [price]."* Only say it if it's true.

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5. Your one-pager (fill it in, then use it everywhere)

- **Who I help:** [trade] in [area]
- **What I see:** [their customers search Google and find a competitor / a broken page / nothing]
- **What I do:** [your one-line offer from section 2]
- **Packages:** Starter [$] · Get Calls [$ + $/mo] · Grow [$/mo]
- **Proof:** [a preview site you built for them, or your first case study]
- **Next step:** [call / text / walk-in], [your name], [phone], [business address]

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